European private higher education: market map, memo and sources

22 October 2026. Part 1 is the investment memo, Part 2 the market map and shortlist, Part 3 the source list. The dataset is in eu_private_he_market_map.xlsx (sheets: Operators, Brands, Scoring method, Precedents, Country matrix).

Part 1

Investment memo: private higher education operators in Europe

22 October 2026. Prepared for a control-buyout mandate. Companion files: `operators.xlsx`, `precedents.xlsx`, `country_matrix.xlsx`, `market_map.md`, `sources.md`.

Assumptions

The brief left some parameters open. This memo assumes:

- Enterprise value EUR 50m to 300m, control deals, as confirmed.
- Equity cheque EUR 30m to 150m, consistent with 3x to 5x leverage on EUR 10m to 40m EBITDA.
- Five-year hold, 2.5x money multiple and 20% IRR hurdle.
- All European geographies weighted equally, as confirmed. The country attractiveness ratings in `country_matrix.xlsx` then drive the ordering.
- No hard exclusions beyond the scope definition. Accredited vocational and professional groups are included because they are where most sponsor activity below EUR 300m has happened. K-12, language schools and pure software remain out.
- Figures are as reported in the cited source. Where only an estimate exists it is labelled as such. Roughly a quarter of the 203 operators have a disclosed revenue figure.

1. Market size and growth by country

Private higher education in Europe is large in four markets, meaningful in four more, and immaterial elsewhere. The figures below are the latest found; sources are in the country matrix.

Country	Private HE scale	Growth signal	Attractiveness (1 to 5)
Spain	25.7% of 1.76m students in 2023-24; 53% of master's students; private HE revenue EUR 3.7bn (DBK, 2023)	Fastest-growing private share in Europe; Ministry forecasts further private growth	4
France	799,700 private students, 26.5% of total (SIES 2024-25)	Growth slowed to +1.1% in 2024 from +2.8%; apprenticeship aid cut from Mar 2026	3
Germany	342,600 students at private HEIs, 11.6% share (WS 2021-22; up from 1.6% in 2001)	Distance learning drives growth; Nov 2025 Berlin court ruling restricts §16b visas for mainly online formats	4
United Kingdom	c. 2.9m HE students; c. 200+ registered alternative providers; largest for-profit cash generators are franchised colleges (ESL GBP 103m, LSST GBP 84m)	Visa restrictions since Jan 2024, Graduate Route cut to 18 months from Jan 2027, levy, franchise crackdown, OfS pause on new degree-awarding powers from 22 Oct 2026	3

Country	Private HE scale	Growth signal	Attractiveness (1 to 5)
Italy	Telematic universities 307,861 students in 2024-25, +158.6% in six years, 15% of all students	Online growth capped by DM 1835 of Dec 2024 (teacher ratios, 20% synchronous, in-person exams); only 11 telematic licences exist	3
Poland	278 non-public institutions; enrolment +27% over five years to 2021; c. 108k foreign students 2024-25	2025 cap of 50% foreign students per university and visa tightening	4
Cyprus	57,889 tertiary students 2023-24 (+9.4%), c. 43k at private universities of which c. 29k foreign	Athens branch licences for UNIC and EUC (2026) under court challenge	5
Greece	13 foreign universities applied for branch status in 2025; Metropolitan College alone >22k students	Council of State annulled three non-state licences in Aug 2026	4
Norway	Lumi NOK 508m revenue (+12.5%); Kristiania c. 20k and BI c. 21.6k students (both foundations)	Non-EEA tuition since 2023 cut new non-EEA students c. 80% at public institutions	4
Netherlands	Salta Group EUR 333m (down from EUR 373m); Nyenrode EUR 77m	Internationalisation bill pending; OCW fines on Salta overturned Sept 2026	3
Switzerland	Hospitality cluster c. 20k students (Sommet 10k, SEG 6k, EHL 3.3k)	Title regulation and non-EU reliance	3
Ireland	Private colleges c. 25k to 30k students	Stable QQI regime, no fee caps, strong international demand	3
Portugal	c. 92,500 private students, 20% of total	Cooperative and foundation dominated	2
Sweden	No for-profit degree route; state-funded YH segment (AcadeMedia Adult Education SEK 1.8bn)	MYH expanding places in tech and health	3
Austria, Czechia, Hungary, Croatia, Baltics	Sub-scale: SFU 6.2k, AMBIS 7.3k, METU c. 10k, Algebra 2.6k	Oakley's 2026 SFU buyout shows sponsor interest in Austria	2 to 3
Belgium, Denmark, Finland, Luxembourg, Romania, Bulgaria, Slovenia, Slovakia, Malta	No realistic for-profit degree market or non-profit requirement	1 to 2	

2. Demand drivers

- Public capacity constraints. Spain, Italy and Poland cap or ration public places in medicine, health sciences and business; private operators fill the gap at full price. Spanish privates now take 53% of master's enrolment.
- Online and hybrid adoption. Italy's telematic segment, Germany's distance-learning providers (IU, AKAD, HFH), UNIR and Unicaf show double-digit growth where the licence permits scale. The regulatory response (Italy's DM 1835, Germany's §16b ruling, Spain's online-university approval by parliament) is now the main constraint on this driver.
- International students. The UK, Cyprus, Poland, Germany and the Netherlands have relied on non-EU recruitment. 2024 to 2026 policy in all five has tightened. Operators with majority-domestic intake (Lumi, Cesur, IRO, Metropolitan College, UCJC) carry less of this risk.

- Apprenticeship and public funding in France. The 2018 reform built groups like Eduservices (32k of 40k students on apprenticeships) and Groupe Alternance; the cuts to employer aid from March 2026 and to distance-CFA funding from July 2025 are reversing the tailwind. Entries fell 16.4% to May 2026.
- Professional and health licences. Medicine (IRO, UniCamillus, Humanitas, UAX, UCAM), law (ULaw, BPP), hospitality (Sommet, SEG, EHL) and music or film (BIMM) command pricing power because the degree is a licence to practise or a scarce brand.

3. Consolidation history, 2015 to 2026

`precedents.xlsx` holds 168 rows. The pattern has three phases.

Phase one, 2015 to 2018: Laureate's European exit. Laureate sold Glion and Les Roches to Eurazeo (CHF 380m, c. 13.6x, 2016), Universidad Europea to Permira (EUR 770m, 2018), its Italian and Cyprus schools to Galileo (EUR 225m, 2017) and its German universities to GUS (2018). Galileo under Providence bought Studialis (EUR 250m, 2015). Oakley bought Career Partner Group, now IU, for EUR 85m of equity for 79% on EUR 10m EBITDA (2017).

Phase two, 2019 to 2022: large-cap platforms. CVC bought UAX (c. EUR 1.1bn, 2019) and 50% of Multiversity (EUR 225m, 10x to 15x, 2019; the rest in 2021 at c. USD 1.6bn). Cinven bought INSEEC, now Omnes (c. EUR 800m, 13x to 14x, 2019). Téthys, CPPIB, Montagu and Bpifrance bought Galileo from Providence (EUR 2.3bn to 2.5bn, c. 18x, 2020). Ardian bought AD Education (EUR 600m, c. 19x to 20x, 2020) and Study Group (c. GBP 500m, 2019). TDR bought BPP (c. GBP 700m, 2021). KKR bought MasterD and MEDAC (EUR 150m and EUR 200m). IK bought Skill & You (2021), ICG bought BIMM (2020), Galileo bought AKAD (>EUR 45m, 2022).

Phase three, 2023 to 2026: secondaries, continuation funds and stress. CVC moved Multiversity into a continuation fund at EUR 3.97bn (2024). Oakley moved IU into a continuation vehicle (2023) and wrote it down in 2025-26. EQT Infrastructure bought 64% of Universidad Europea at c. EUR 2.0bn to 2.2bn, c. 20x (2024). TDR's BPP auction at GBP 2.5bn failed (2024). Cinven and Mubadala bought UAX from CVC at c. EUR 2.0bn, c. 17x (Oct 2025). Proeduca delisted at EUR 1.54bn equity, c. 22x (2025). Below EUR 300m, BC Partners bought Metropolitan College (EUR 210m to 230m, c. 9x, 2023), Nextalia bought 24ORE Business School (EUR 200m, 2023), Jacobs bought Ilerna (>EUR 400m, 2024), Oakley bought Sigmund Freud University (2026), and GUS and Brightstar took Study Group out of Ardian in a distressed deal (May 2026). Refinancings dominate 2025-26: BPP GBP 710m TLB, Universidad Europea EUR 975m TLB with a EUR 300m dividend, Omnes c. EUR 700m, Galileo on S&P negative outlook.

4. Active sponsors

Sponsor	European HE positions	Posture
CVC	Multiversity (continuation fund), QA (incl. QA Higher Education); exited UAX 2025	Seller of QAHE; long holder of Multiversity
Cinven	Omnes, UAX (2025), EU Business School via Omnes	Buyer at large cap; refinancing Omnes
EQT	Universidad Europea (Infrastructure VI)	New entrant via infrastructure fund; Portugal non-core
Permira	35% of Universidad Europea	Partial exit done
Oakley Capital	IU Group, Sigmund Freud University (2026)	Building a second DACH platform; IU under stress
Ardian	AD Education, SAE Europe; exited Study Group 2026	AD Education sale shelved 2023; exit pending
Téthys, CPPIB, Montagu, Bpifrance	Galileo Global Education	Leveraged; possible unit disposals
TDR Capital	BPP	Failed sale 2024, refinanced 2025

Sponsor	European HE positions	Posture
KKR Global Impact	Davante (MasterD, MEDAC, UTAMED)	Year 5 to 6; exit 2026 to 2028
ICG	BIMM University Group	Year 6; refinanced Jan 2026
Bridgepoint	Cambridge Education Group	Year 12; overdue
IK Partners	Skill & You; sold Ilerna 2024	Exit window open
BC Partners	Metropolitan College (Greece)	Exit 2027 to 2029
Eurazeo	Sommet Education	Two failed sales; overdue
Jacobs Holding	Ilerna, Isabel I	Long-dated buyer in Spain
Investindustrial	Campus Training (Spain)	Year 5
Nextalia	Digit'Ed (Italy)	Exit 2027 to 2029
Summer Capital	Swiss Education Group	Year 8
Brightstar Capital	50% Arden, Study Group (JV with GUS)	New UK entrant, distressed angle
THI Investments	Oxford International	Family office, long-dated
Magnum, Q Impact, Robus, Invision, Hanover	Metrodora, Linkia, YrkesAkademin, eduPRO, Lumi	Mid-market, exit windows 2026 to 2028

5. Returns earned by prior sponsors

Disclosed or derivable returns are few. Those found:

- Palamon on 24ORE Business School: entry c. EUR 80m (2017, c. 17x), exit EUR 200m to Nextalia (2023); reported 3.9x and 29% IRR.
- Oakley on IU: EUR 85m equity for 79% (2017); 2023 sale to its own continuation vehicle generated GBP 240m of proceeds for Oakley Capital Investments and a reported 85% gross IRR; 2025-26 write-down.
- Providence on Galileo: Studialis bought for EUR 250m (2015); group sold at EUR 2.3bn to 2.5bn (2020), c. 18x EBITDA.
- Permira on Universidad Europea: EUR 770m entry (2018) to c. EUR 2.0bn to 2.2bn (2024) with 35% retained, roughly 2.6x to 2.9x on EV in five and a half years before leverage.
- CVC on UAX: c. EUR 1.1bn entry (2019) to c. EUR 2.0bn (2025), roughly 1.8x on EV in six years before leverage.
- CVC on Multiversity: EUR 225m for 50% at c. EUR 500m to 750m EV (2019) to EUR 3.97bn (2024), but to its own continuation fund.
- Laureate on Glion and Les Roches: CHF 380m (2016) after years of under-investment; Eurazeo has not exited after ten years.
- Capital destroyed: CapMan sold YrkesAkademin for SEK 1 after a reconstruction clearing SEK 585m of debt (2024); Ardian sold Study Group in a distressed deal with the legacy holding company put into administration (2026); INTO has negative equity after a thirteen-year minority hold by Leeds Equity.

Median disclosed EBITDA multiple across the four cleanly reported platform deals is c. 15.8x; large platforms cluster at 17x to 22x. Mid-market entries have been materially cheaper: Metropolitan College c. 9x, Multiversity's first tranche 10x to 15x, Groupe EDH 15x, Sommet 13.6x.

6. Key risks

- Regulatory licence risk is the dominant loss-of-capital risk. Examples from the last 24 months: Italy's DM 1835 teacher-ratio rules and the ANVUR finding against Pegaso; Spain's RD 905/2025 on new universities, annulled Oct 2026 and now being re-enacted; the UK franchise crackdown, levy and OfS pause on degree-awarding powers; Germany's §16b visa ruling against IU; Poland's 50% foreign-student cap; Greece's Council of State annulments; the French bill creating a two-tier approval with non-profit-only "intérêt général" status, adopted by the Senate June 2026.
- International student dependence. Cyprus, UK pathways, Polish privates and German online providers earn most growth from non-EU students. Policy turned in 2024 and has not turned back.
- Leverage at the platforms. Galileo (S&P B negative), IU (EUR 500m TLB due 2028, write-down), Omnes (c. 7x gross debt to EBITDA on refinancing), GUS (7.2x in 2020, TLB due 2027), Multiversity (B2/B) all carry structures that limit their ability to buy and may force unit sales.
- Public funding reversal. France's apprenticeship cuts and the UK fee cap and loan rules for franchised provision show how fast funded models deteriorate.
- Reputational events. Collegium Humanum in Poland (compulsory administration, convictions, full-tuition refunds), Link Campus and eCampus probes in Italy, UK loan-fraud investigations at franchised colleges.
- Entry price. The 2019 to 2024 large-cap multiples of 17x to 22x assumed growth that regulation is now capping; several sponsors are stuck (BPP, Sommet, AD Education, IU). The mid-market has cleared at 9x to 15x.

7. Recommended sourcing angle

The large platforms are either too big, recently traded, or over-levered. The actionable pool at EUR 50m to 300m has three shapes.

First, sponsor exits that are overdue or signalled. QA Higher Education (CVC, sale intent on record), BIMM (ICG, year six, refinanced), Cambridge Education Group (Bridgepoint, year twelve), Skill & You (IK, year five), Metropolitan College (BC Partners, in range, cheap entry), Digit'Ed (Nextalia), Swiss Education Group (Summer Capital, year eight). Approach the sponsor and the lenders directly; several of these will not run clean auctions.

Second, founder and family succession in Germany, Spain and Ireland. IRO Group's medical schools, ESO's ISM and Munich Business School, Cesur, UCJC, Nebrija, UEMC, UDIMA, Griffith College, Groupe Ynov, MediaSchool. These are the assets most likely to sell at 9x to 13x. The work is registry pulls (Bundesanzeiger, Registro Mercantil, CRO, Infogreffe) to size them, followed by principal-to-founder conversations.

Third, carve-outs from leveraged or non-core owners. Ensilis from EQT's Universidad Europea, Galileo's Nordic and German units, AD Education's SAE and ICMP, Sommet's École Ducasse, Planeta's French schools, Cognos's AMBIS, Salta's Tio or LOI, AcadeMedia's YH operators. These need a view on brand licences and shared services, and a seller under pressure, which Galileo, Omnes and IU now are.

Underwriting discipline should favour majority-domestic intake, licences that are scarce or hard to replicate (medicine, law, own degree-awarding powers, Italian telematic licences), limited reliance on public funding, and net leverage below 4x at entry. Norway, Spain, Germany, Greece and Cyprus rank highest on the country matrix for a for-profit control owner; the UK offers the deepest deal flow but the weakest regulatory tailwind in 2026-27.

8. Next steps for the deal team

1. Pull filed accounts for the 15 shortlisted names (list and registries in `market_map.md`). This converts estimate-based scores to disclosed ones and is the largest data gap.

2. Verify the three single-source items that matter most: Universidad Europea's Jan 2026 recap, Groupe EDH's 2022 sponsor, and the Oakley continuation-vehicle terms for IU.
3. Commission a regulatory read on Spain's re-enacted RD 905 and the UK Immigration White Paper implementation, since both change the shortlist ordering.
4. Open conversations with CVC (QAHE), ICG (BIMM) and Bridgepoint (CEG) in the UK and with the IRO and ESO families in Germany.

Part 2

European private higher education: market map and shortlist

Prepared 22 October 2026 for a control-buyout mandate at EUR 50m to 300m enterprise value. Companion files: `operators.xlsx` (203 operators, 196 brands, weighted scores), `precedents.xlsx` (168 transaction and financing rows, 2015 to 2026), `country_matrix.xlsx` (30 countries), `memo.md`, `sources.md`.

Confidence note: roughly one operator in four has a disclosed revenue figure. Most German, Polish, Cypriot and Italian operators carry "n/a" with the registry named that holds the accounts. Every score in `operators.xlsx` is flagged disclosed, estimate or mixed. The web-search budget ran out part-way through every workstream, so the long tail was verified by direct page fetches rather than fresh searches.

1. Segmentation

Axis 1, delivery model. Axis 2, geographic footprint (single-country operator versus multi-country platform). Operators in bold are inside or adjacent to the EUR 50m to 300m EV range with a plausible control route. Operators marked (F) are foundation, association or church owned with no realistic conversion route; they are listed as competitors or acquisition targets only.

1a. Campus universities and universities of applied sciences

Footprint	Operators
Multi-country platform	Universidad Europea (EQT 64% / Permira 35%; Spain, Portugal), Global University Systems (Etingen; UK, Germany, Ireland, Canada), Galileo Global Education (Téthys / CPPIB / Montagu / Bpifrance; France, Germany, Italy, Cyprus, Norway, UK), IU Group (Oakley; Germany, online across Europe), AMBIS / Carl Remigius Fresenius (Czechia, Germany)
Single-country, scaled (>10k students)	UAX (Cinven / Mubadala, Spain), UNIR / Proeduca (Arrufat / Sofina / Portobello, Spain), UCAM (F, Spain), **Universidad Camilo José Cela (SEK family, Spain)**, **Universidad Nebrija (three-shareholder SA, Spain)**, **UDIMA (CEF family, Spain)**, Hochschule Fresenius (Fresenius / Oetker families, Germany), SRH University (F, Germany), FOM (F, Germany), **WSB Merito (founder-controlled, Poland)**, **SWPS (founder, Poland)**, **VIZJA (Poland)**, **Akademia WSB (founder, Poland)**, University of Nicosia / EDEX (Peristianis, Cyprus), European University Cyprus (Galileo), Kristiania (F, Norway), BI (F, Norway), Salta Group / Tio / NCOI (van Zanten, Netherlands), Lusófona / COFAC (cooperative, Portugal)
Single-country, mid-size (3k to 10k)	**IRO Group: MSH Hamburg, MSB Berlin, HMU, BSP (Renken-Olthoff, Germany)**, **Diploma Hochschule (Bernd-Blindow family, Germany)**, **IST-Hochschule (Germany)**, **Hochschule für angewandtes Management (Germany)**, **Sigmund Freud PrivatUniversität (Oakley, Austria, acquired 2026)**, Kalaidos (Klett, Switzerland), **UEMC Valladolid (founder families, Spain)**, **Frederick University (family, Cyprus)**, Neapolis Pafos (Leptos family, Cyprus), **Griffith College (Hegarty, Ireland)**, Dublin Business School (Kaplan Inc), **Lumi Gruppen / Oslo Nye Høyskole (listed, Hanover 60%, Norway)**, Łazarski (Poland), Vistula (Poland), Kozminski (F, Poland), AMBIS (Cognos, Czechia), UNYP (Foutsis family, Czechia), Budapest Metropolitan (Hungary), Algebra Bernays (founders, Croatia), University of Buckingham (F, UK), Northeastern London (F, UK), Regent's (Galileo, UK), Humanitas University (Humanitas group, Italy), UniCamillus (founder-led, Italy), UniSR (F, Italy), Nebrija
Single-country, small (<3k)	Wittenborg (Netherlands), accadis, FH Wedel, Media University, Quadriga, HdWM, Whitecliffe, DBU (Germany), Webster Vienna, Lauder, Modul (Austria), SBS, HWZ, Franklin, Webster Geneva (Switzerland), John Cabot, Link Campus (Italy), Varna UM, Turiba, RISEBA, TSI, EBS Tallinn, Alma Mater Europaea, PEVS, AU Malta, LIS London

1b. Business schools and grandes écoles

Footprint	Operators
Multi-country platform	Omnes Education (Cinven; France, Switzerland via EU Business School, Spain, Monaco), Planeta Formación y Universidades (Lara family; Spain, France via EDC and ESLSCA, Italy via Rome Business School), Galileo (ESG, Paris School of Business, 40% of emlyon)
Single-country	IE University (del Alcázar family, Spain), ESADE, ESIC, CEU, IESE, Navarra (F, Spain), **ESO Education Group: ISM and Munich Business School (Semidei family, Germany)**, CBS / EU

1c. Online and hybrid universities

Footprint	Operators
Multi-country platform	IU Group (Oakley; c. EUR 500m revenue, 150k+ students, EUR 500m TLB due 2028, §16b visa ruling Nov 2025), UNIR / Proeduca (Spain, Mexico; EUR 348m revenue FY24, delisted 2025 at EUR 1.54bn equity), Unicaf (EDEX / BII / University Ventures; 80k+ students), Studi (Galileo; EUR 107m FY25), **Skill & You (IK Partners since 2021; c. EUR 115m revenue, France)**, Learna / Diploma MSc (Reducate, UK)
Single-country	Multiversity: Pegaso, Mercatorum, San Raffaele Roma (CVC continuation fund; EUR 592m revenue, EUR 290m EBITDA FY25, 243k students), eCampus / Polidori (42.7k students, Italy), Unicusano (Bandecchi, Italy), Guglielmo Marconi (F), Uninettuno (F), Giustino Fortunato (small, Italy), UDIMA (Spain), Universidad Isabel I (Ilerna / Jacobs), UTAMED (Davante / KKR), Arden University (GUS / Brightstar JV; GBP 189m revenue FY24), AKAD, HFH (F), Wilhelm Büchner, Euro-FH / Apollon (Klett), SRH Fernhochschule (F), LOI / NTI (Salta, Netherlands), Walter Learning, Icademie (France)

1d. Specialist schools: creative, hospitality, health, music, design

Footprint	Operators
Multi-country platform	AD Education (Ardian; c. EUR 400m revenue pro forma, France, Italy, Spain, Germany, UK via SAE and ICMP), Galileo creative brands (Istituto Marangoni, NABA, Domus, Cours Florent, LISAA, Penninghen, Strate, Macromedia, Noroff, Nackademin), Sommet Education (Eurazeo since 2016; Glion, Les Roches, École Ducasse, Invictus; c. 10k students), **Swiss Education Group (Summer Capital since 2018; >6k students)**, Le Cordon Bleu (Cointreau family), Vatel (Sebbane family), IED (F, Italy, Spain, Brazil; EUR 75m revenue), Istituto Marangoni, **Metrodora Education (Magnum, Spain; health)**
Single-country	**BIMM University Group incl. Met Film School (ICG since 2020; GBP 68m income, GBP 23m EBITDA FY25, UK)**, **Point Blank Music School (Cowan, UK)**, ACM, ICMP (AD Education), Escape Studios (Pearson JV), EHL (F), BHMS (Bénédict family), **Carl Remigius Medical School / Hochschule Fresenius health (Germany)**, **IRO Group medical schools (Germany)**, **UniCamillus (Italy)**, Humanitas (Italy), Accademia Costume & Moda (Lanzara family, Italy), Polimoda (F), Institut Lyfe (F, France), Groupe Ynov (tech / creative; founder, France), Hibernia College (Folens, Ireland), Egas Moniz, CESPU (cooperatives, Portugal)

1e. Pathway, foundation and international-college providers

Footprint	Operators
Multi-country platform	Study Group (Arete Education: GUS / Brightstar JV, distressed acquisition May 2026), INTO University Partnerships (founder / Leeds Equity; GBP 144m statutory turnover, GBP 18.7m adj. EBITDA, negative equity), Kaplan International Pathways (Graham Holdings; GBP 222m revenue), Navitas UK (BGH Capital), **Cambridge Education Group / ONCAMPUS (Bridgepoint since 2013, UK)**, **Oxford International Education Group (THI since 2021, UK)**

Footprint	Operators
Single-country	**QA Higher Education (CVC via QA Ltd; >10k students, UK)**, Global Banking School (Rana; >35k students), Elizabeth School of London (GBP 103m revenue FY25), LSST (GBP 84m, 15 months), LCCA (GUS), Nelson College, Regent College London, Oxford Business College, LSME (UK franchised providers), Metropolitan College (BC Partners, Greece; UK-validated), New York College, Mediterranean College, City Unity (Greece), CITY College Thessaloniki (York)

1f. Accredited vocational and professional groups (degree-adjacent)

Footprint	Operators
Multi-country platform	BPP Education Group (TDR; GBP 402m turnover FY24, failed GBP 2.5bn auction 2024, GBP 710m TLB 2025), Davante: MasterD + MEDAC + UTAMED (KKR Global Impact; >EUR 250m revenue, Spain), Ilerna + Isabel I (Jacobs Holding; EUR 60m revenue), Eduservices (Grassaud family recap 2025, c. EUR 350m, France), AcadeMedia Adult Education (listed, SEK 1.8bn, Sweden)
Single-country	**Cesur / Grupo Coremsa (Martín family; c. EUR 70m revenue target, 80k students, Spain)**, Universae (Spain), Linkia FP (Q Impact), Campus Training (Investindustrial since 2021, Spain), **Groupe Alternance (France)**, **eduPRO (Invision since 2022, Austria)**, YrkesAkademin (Robus), EC Utbildning, Iris / MedLearn (Sweden), Noroff + Nackademin (Galileo), Niels Brock (F, Denmark), TEB / Cosinus (Poland)

2. Ownership map of the scaled platforms (context for carve-outs and secondaries)

Platform	Sponsor	Entry	Last known EV	Status relevant to us
Multiversity	CVC continuation fund	2019 / 2021 / 2024	EUR 3.97bn (2024)	Too large; San Raffaele Roma and Certipass / Aulab are separable; ANVUR Nov 2025 finding on Pegaso course compliance
Galileo Global Education	Téthys, CPPIB, Montagu, Bpifrance	2020	EUR 2.3bn to 2.5bn	S&P B negative outlook Nov 2025; Nordic (Noroff, Nackademin), German (Macromedia, AKAD) and Cyprus (EUC) units are carve-out candidates if the syndicate rationalises
Universidad Europea	EQT Infrastructure VI 64%, Permira 35%	2024	EUR 2.0bn to 2.2bn, c. 20x	Portugal (Ensilis: Universidade Europeia, IADE, IPAM) is a natural carve-out
UAX	Cinven, Mubadala, founder	2025 (closing 2026)	c. EUR 2.0bn, c. 17x	New sponsor; no action
UNIR / Proeduca	Arrufat family, Sofina, Portobello	2025 delisting	EUR 1.54bn equity, c. 22x	Permanent-capital holders; no action
BPP	TDR Capital	2021	GBP 2.5bn sought, c. 16.7x; no deal	Refinanced 2025; a future break-up could release BPP University
IU Group	Oakley Fund V + continuation vehicle	2017 / 2023	>EUR 1bn sought 2023	OCI write-down 2025-26, c. EUR 790m liabilities, visa ruling; recap risk, not a target at our size
Omnes Education	Cinven	2019	c. EUR 800m, 13x to 14x	c. EUR 700m refinancing launched Oct 2026, EUR 216m converts due 2029, student unrest; EU Business School (Switzerland) separable
AD Education	Ardian	2020	c. EUR 600m, c. 19x to 20x; >EUR 1.5bn sought 2023	Sale prep shelved 2023; SAE, ICMP, Spanish and Italian units separable

Platform	Sponsor	Entry	Last known EV	Status relevant to us
Sommet Education	Eurazeo	2016	CHF 380m entry, c. 13.6x	Two failed processes (2020, 2021); École Ducasse and Invictus separable
GUS	Etingen family	n/a	EUR 1bn TLB due 2027, 7.2x (Moody's 2020)	Arden 50% sold to Brightstar 2025; Study Group bought 2026; UK assets may be monetised
Davante	KKR Global Impact	2020 / 2021	EUR 150m + EUR 200m entry	Year 5 to 6; whole group above range
Metropolitan College / AKMI	BC Partners	2023	EUR 210m to 230m for 85% to 90%, c. 8.4x to 9.2x	Secondary 2027 to 2029; in range

3. Ranked shortlist (control, EUR 50m to 300m EV)

Scores are the weighted score from `operators.xlsx` (1 to 5). "Basis" says whether the score rests on disclosed figures. The ranking below also applies judgement on deal timing that the mechanical score does not capture.

#	Target	Country	Owner and route	Scale (source)	Why it ranks here	Key diligence issue
1	QA Higher Education	UK	CVC Fund VI (2017); Rothschild sale mandate 2023 not completed; carved into QAHE Holdings Dec 2022; new board May 2026	>10,000 students; accounts filed but scanned	Only UK asset where the sponsor has already signalled a sale and the entity is pre-carved. Likely GBP 50m to 150m EV	Franchise and international-recruitment exposure; OfS registration and B3 metrics; Immigration White Paper effects
2	BIMM University Group (incl. Met Film School)	UK	ICG since 2020; equity injection and refinancing Jan 2026	GBP 68.4m income, GBP 23.1m EBITDA FY25 (down from 34.8m)	Six-year hold, own degree-awarding powers, EBITDA decline and refinancing make a secondary at a reset price plausible in 2027	Enrolment trend, Graduate Route change from Jan 2027, lender position
3	Metropolitan College and IEK AKMI (Alphabet Education)	Greece	BC Partners Greek fund since Apr 2023	c. EUR 60m to 70m revenue, c. EUR 25m EBITDA (press est.)	Entry at c. 9x; the only sponsor-owned asset in Southern Europe that is squarely in range; exit window 2027 to 2029	Aug 2026 Council of State annulment of rival non-state licences signals litigation risk around the 2024 law
4	Lumi Gruppen / Oslo Nye Høyskole	Norway	Listed (Euronext Oslo), Hanover Active Equity Fund III 60.1%	NOK 508m revenue 2025 (+12.5%), H1 2026 adj. EBITA margin 20%	Thin float plus a fund-controlled block makes a take-private clean; disclosed numbers; clear for-profit route	Whether ONH receives state grants and so faces profit-distribution limits; Sonans (exam prep) mix
5	IRO Group (MSH Hamburg, MSB Berlin, HMU, BSP)	Germany	Founder Ilona Renken-Olthoff since 2009; succession	c. 8,000+ students; three full medicine licences; financials n/a (Bundesanzeiger)	Scarce medical degree licences, clean accreditation, single owner. The best founder story in DACH	No filed figures pulled yet; Land-level recognition terms; founder willingness
6	Cambridge Education Group / ONCAMPUS	UK	Bridgepoint since 2013	Scanned FY25 accounts; CATS sold 2019 for c. GBP 150m	Twelve-year hold is overdue; pathways plus CEG Digital plus iheed	Pathway volumes under the visa regime; partner-university contracts
7	Cesur / Grupo Coremsa	Spain	Martín family, second generation	c. EUR 70m revenue target, c. 80,000 students	Largest independent vocational group left after KKR, Jacobs and Investindustrial bought the others; succession-driven process plausible	Non-degree; FP regulation by region; need Registro Mercantil accounts

#	Target	Country	Owner and route	Scale (source)	Why it ranks here	Key diligence issue
8	ESO Education Group HE carve-out (ISM, Munich Business School)	Germany	Semidei family	n/a (Bundesanzeiger)	Two AACSB-accredited business schools inside a mixed vocational group; family could sell HE to focus	Carve-out complexity; student counts to verify
9	Groupe EDH (EFAP, ICART, EFJ, Brassart)	France	Sponsor since 2022 (reported Abénex, unverified) after IK minority 2020 at c. EUR 200m, c. 15x	c. 17,000 students, 15 schools, 6 countries	Serial-LBO asset with a 2026 to 2028 exit window; at the top of or just above range	Entry multiple >20x in 2022 means price discipline; French apprenticeship cuts
10	Skill & You	France	IK Partners (IK IX) since 2021	c. EUR 115m revenue 2020, 100% online, c. 120k learners	Fund in year 5 to 6; PitchBook flags a Dec 2025 event; sold Ilerna to Jacobs in 2024	CPF and NPEC funding cuts; completion rates
11	Swiss Education Group	Switzerland	Summer Capital (Hong Kong) since 2018	>6,000 students, 5 campuses	Eight-year hold by a non-specialist owner; hospitality brand	No HEdA institutional accreditation (Derby validation); reliance on non-EU demand
12	Universidad Camilo José Cela / Nebrija	Spain	SEK family / three-shareholder SA	UCJC 11,260 students, budget c. EUR 53m; Nebrija c. 12,000 students, >EUR 60m revenue band	Two family-owned Madrid universities with profitability pressure (UCJC) or board change (Nebrija, May 2026); both sit in range	RD 905/2025 was annulled Oct 2026 but the Government is re-enacting identical rules; need filed accounts
13	Griffith College	Ireland	Diarmuid Hegarty since 1974	c. 8,000 students, EUR 200m campus plan	Succession plus capital need; QQI regime stable; no fee cap	CRO accounts; scale likely at the lower end of range
14	Ensilis (Universidade Europeia, IADE, IPAM)	Portugal	Subsidiary of Universidad Europea (EQT)	est. EUR 30m to 60m revenue	Non-core to an infrastructure-fund owner; natural carve-out	Transfer-pricing and brand licence; Portuguese RJIES for-profit rules
15	Digit'Ed / 24ORE Business School	Italy	Nextalia since 2023 (EUR 200m reported)	Digit'Ed FY22 revenue EUR 41m; 15k+ participants a year	The only Italian education asset with a sponsor exit in 2027 to 2029 in range	Non-degree; dependence on 24 ORE brand licence

Watch-list, above range or recently acquired: Davante (KKR, 2020 to 2021 vintage), Campus Training (Investindustrial, 2021), WSB Merito and University of Nicosia (founder groups with no financials), INTO (distressed recap rather than buyout), Sommet Education and École Ducasse (Eurazeo, ten-year hold), AD Education's SAE and ICMP, Galileo's Nordic and German units, Planeta's French schools, Sigmund Freud University (Oakley bought 2026, shows Oakley building a second DACH platform).

4. How the map was built and what is missing

- 203 operators across 30 countries, scored on six dimensions with weights in the `Scoring method` sheet.
- Filed revenue or EBITDA was retrieved for roughly 50 operators. The rest need registry pulls: Companies House OCR (UK scanned PDFs), Bundesanzeiger (Germany), Registro Mercantil (Spain), KRS (Poland), Cyprus registrar, Infogreffe (France), Cerved (Italy).
- Several anchor assumptions in the original brief were wrong and are corrected in the data: Universidad Europea is EQT-owned, not in a Permira sale; UAX went to Cinven and Mubadala in Oct 2025; UNIR delisted in 2025; Ilerna is Jacobs-owned, not Ardian; MEDAC and MasterD are KKR's Davante; AKAD is Galileo-owned; Modul Vienna is owned by Hungary's MCC; ISM Lithuania is controlled by KTU; AD Education's prior owners were founder plus Cathay and Bpifrance, not Eurazeo or Sagard.

Part 3

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